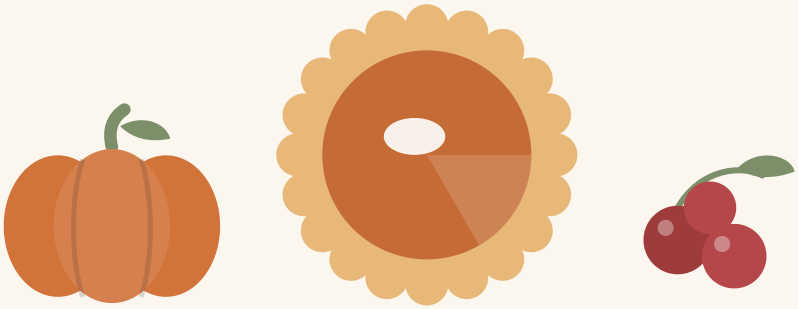


PRINTABLE PLANNER · 19 PAGES

Thanksgiving

Host Planner

Everything you need to plan a calm, delicious Thanksgiving: menu, countdown, hour-by-hour timeline, shopping list, seating chart and place cards.

- Menu + potluck sign-up
- Turkey guide
- Hour-by-hour timeline
- Shopping list
- Seating chart
- Place cards + food labels

Hosted by _____ *in* _____

Welcome, host

Plan it in four steps

1. **Three weeks out:** fill in the guest list, the menu and the potluck sign-up. Decide on your turkey size with the turkey guide.
2. **Two weeks out:** work through the countdown checklist and plan what you can make ahead.
3. **The week of:** write the shopping list by aisle, plan your seating and print the place cards and food labels.
4. **The day before:** fill in your own timeline and oven schedule (the sample timeline shows how), then set the table and relax.

Printing tips

- Print at “Actual size” or “100%”.
- Print only the pages you need; print the place cards and food labels on card stock if you have it.
- Pages look great in color and work fine in black and white.
- Keep the pages together in a folder or on a clipboard in the kitchen.

Our Thanksgiving at a glance

Date: _____

Dinner time: _____

Number of guests: _____

Turkey size: _____

Guests arrive at: _____

What’s inside

1	Cover
2	Welcome
3	Countdown checklist
4	Guest list & RSVPs
5	Menu planner
6	Potluck sign-up
7	Make-ahead plan
8	Shopping list by aisle
9	Turkey guide
10	Sample timeline (3 PM dinner)
11	My Thanksgiving Day timeline
12	Oven & stovetop schedule
13	Table & supplies checklist
14	Seating chart: long table
15	Seating chart: round tables
16	Place cards: pumpkin
17	Place cards: leaves
18	Buffet food labels
19	Leftovers & notes for next year

A host’s secret: label every serving dish with a sticky note the day before (“green beans”, “gravy”), with the serving spoon inside. On the day, anyone can help you plate up.

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Countdown checklist

THREE WEEKS TO DINNER



3 WEEKS BEFORE

Invite & decide

- [ ] Set the date, time and guest list
- [ ] Send invitations (text, call or card)
- [ ] Plan the menu; ask guests what they'd like to bring
- [ ] Order a fresh turkey or buy a frozen one
- [ ] Check chairs, plates, glasses, serving dishes, roasting pan and a meat thermometer
- [ ]

2 WEEKS BEFORE

Shop the basics

- [ ] Buy drinks and pantry staples
- [ ] Plan the table, decorations and seating
- [ ] Make and freeze what you can (pie dough, rolls, soup)
- [ ] Borrow or buy anything missing from the supplies list
- [ ]
- [ ]

1 WEEK BEFORE

Confirm & clear

- [ ] Confirm RSVPs and dietary needs
- [ ] Confirm the potluck sign-up with each guest
- [ ] Write the fresh-food shopping list
- [ ] Clear space in the fridge and freezer
- [ ] Frozen turkey? Count back the thawing days (turkey guide)
- [ ]

2–3 DAYS BEFORE

Shop & prep

- [ ] Shop for produce, dairy and bread
- [ ] Make cranberry sauce and dips
- [ ] Chop onions, celery and herbs; store in containers
- [ ] Print place cards and food labels
- [ ]
- [ ]

THE DAY BEFORE

Get ahead

- [ ] Bake pies; assemble casseroles to bake tomorrow
- [ ] Set the table and arrange the decorations
- [ ] Label serving dishes with sticky notes
- [ ] Chill drinks; make ice
- [ ] Fill in your timeline and oven schedule
- [ ]

THANKSGIVING DAY

Enjoy it

- [ ] Follow your timeline
- [ ] Empty the dishwasher before guests arrive
- [ ] Set out appetizers and drinks
- [ ] Refrigerate leftovers within 2 hours of serving
- [ ]
- [ ]

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Guest list & RSVPs

WHO'S COMING

NAME / HOUSEHOLD	RSVP	ADULTS	KIDS	BRINGING	ALLERGIES / DIET
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
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	☐				
	☐				
	☐				
	☐				

Total adults: _____ Total kids: _____ Total guests: _____ High chairs / kids' table: _____

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Menu planner

WHAT WE'RE SERVING

DISH	MADE BY	RECIPE / SOURCE	SERVES	GF	VEG
Appetizers					
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
Main					
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
Sides					
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
Bread & sauces					
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
Desserts					
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
Drinks					
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐

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Potluck sign-up

WHO BRINGS WHAT

Hang this on the fridge or send a photo to your guests. Fill in the dishes you need first, then let guests sign up.

CATEGORY	DISH NEEDED	NAME	SERVES	NEEDS OVEN?	CONFIRMED
Appetizer				☐	☐
Appetizer				☐	☐
Side				☐	☐
Side				☐	☐
Side				☐	☐
Side				☐	☐
Salad				☐	☐
Bread / rolls				☐	☐
Dessert				☐	☐
Dessert				☐	☐
Drinks				☐	☐
Drinks				☐	☐
Ice				☐	☐
Extra chairs				☐	☐
To-go containers				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐

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Make-ahead plan

COOK EARLY, RELAX LATER

Pies, cranberry sauce, dips, casseroles and rolls are easy to make 1–3 days early. Write each dish here and the day you'll make it.

DISH	MAKE ON (DAY)	STORE IN	REHEAT / FINISH	DONE
e.g. Pumpkin pie	*Tuesday*	*Fridge*	*Serve at room temp*	☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
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				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

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Shopping list

BY AISLE

Produce

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Meat & turkey

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Dairy & eggs

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Bakery

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Pantry & baking

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Spices & sauces

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Drinks

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Paper goods & other

	QTY
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Store(s): _____ Budget: _____ Spent: _____

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Turkey guide

SIZE · THAW · ROAST

How big?

Plan on about **1 lb per person**, or **1½ lb per person** if you want leftovers. (A 14 lb turkey feeds about 10–14.)

Thawing in the fridge

Allow about **1 day for every 4–5 lb**, in a pan, in a fridge at 40°F or colder.

TURKEY	DAYS TO THAW
4–12 lb	1–3 days
12–16 lb	3–4 days
16–20 lb	4–5 days
20–24 lb	5–6 days

Running late? Thaw in cold water in its wrapper: about 30 minutes per lb, changing the water every 30 minutes, and cook it right away.

Before it goes in

- Take the neck and giblets out of both cavities.
- Don't rinse the raw turkey; pat it dry with paper towels.
- Roast breast-side up on a rack in a shallow pan.

165°F

The turkey is done when a food thermometer reads **165°F** in the thickest part of the thigh, the wing and the breast. Let it rest 20–30 minutes before carving.

Roasting times at 325°F

TURKEY	UNSTUFFED	STUFFED
8–12 lb	2¾–3 hr	3–3½ hr
12–14 lb	3–3¾ hr	3½–4 hr
14–18 lb	3¾–4¼ hr	4–4¼ hr
18–20 lb	4¼–4½ hr	4¼–4¾ hr
20–24 lb	4½–5 hr	4¾–5¼ hr

Times are for a fully thawed turkey and are only a guide (based on USDA guidance). Ovens vary: start checking the temperature 30–45 minutes early. If you stuff the bird, the center of the stuffing must also reach 165°F.

Leftovers

- Refrigerate within 2 hours of serving.
- Carve the meat off the bone and store it in shallow containers.
- Eat within 3–4 days, or freeze.
- Reheat leftovers until hot (165°F).

My turkey

Weight: _____ Fresh / frozen: _____ Pick up / buy on: _____

Start thawing on: _____ Oven on at: _____ Turkey in at: _____

Check temp at: _____ Out to rest at: _____ Carve at: _____

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Sample timeline

DINNER AT 3 PM · 14 LB TURKEY

Use this as a model for your own timeline on the next page. Work backward from your dinner time: rest + roast time + 45 minutes to preheat and prep the turkey.

7:30 AM	Coffee first. Read through today's timeline and oven schedule.
8:00 AM	Set out serving dishes (labeled the day before). Chill drinks.
9:30 AM	Prep stuffing to bake in a dish; peel potatoes and keep them in cold water.
10:00 AM	Preheat the oven to 325°F. Pat the turkey dry and season it.
10:45 AM	**Turkey in the oven (14 lb, unstuffed: about 3–3¾ hours).**
11:30 AM	Prep vegetables and salad. Wash up as you go.
12:30 PM	Shower and get dressed while the turkey roasts.
1:15 PM	Set out appetizers and the drinks station.
1:45 PM	Start checking the turkey temperature (aim for 165°F).
2:00 PM	Guests arrive. Put the potatoes on to boil.
2:15 PM	**Turkey out; cover loosely with foil to rest. Oven up for sides and rolls.**
2:30 PM	Make gravy from the drippings. Mash the potatoes.
2:45 PM	Carve the turkey. Warm rolls. Fill water glasses.
3:00 PM	**Dinner is served!**
4:30 PM	Coffee and pie. Pack leftovers within 2 hours.

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My Thanksgiving Day

HOUR BY HOUR

Dinner at: _____ Turkey weight: _____ Turkey in at: _____ Guests arrive: _____

TIME	TO DO	WHO	DONE
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
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			☐

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Oven & stovetop schedule

WHO GETS THE HEAT, WHEN



The oven is the bottleneck on Thanksgiving. Write each dish in its slot (with temperature) so nothing fights for space. Slow cookers, the microwave and a grill can take the overflow.

TIME	OVEN (TEMP)	STOVETOP	SLOW COOKER / MICRO / OTHER

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Table & supplies

CHECK IT OFF

On the table

- [ ] Tablecloth or runner, napkins
- [ ] Dinner plates and salad / dessert plates
- [ ] Forks, knives, spoons, dessert forks
- [ ] Water glasses and wine / drink glasses
- [ ] Salt and pepper, butter dish
- [ ] Centerpiece and candles
- [ ] Place cards (pages 16–17)
- [ ]
- [ ]

Serving

- [ ] Turkey platter and carving board
- [ ] Serving bowls and spoons (one per dish)
- [ ] Gravy boat and ladle
- [ ] Bread basket
- [ ] Pie server and cake knife
- [ ] Food labels for the buffet (page 18)
- [ ] Trivets
- [ ]
- [ ]

Kitchen tools

- [ ] Roasting pan with rack
- [ ] Meat thermometer
- [ ] Carving knife and fork
- [ ] Baster or large spoon
- [ ] Foil, plastic wrap, parchment
- [ ] Potato masher, whisk for gravy
- [ ] Timer (or two)
- [ ]
- [ ]

Hosting extras

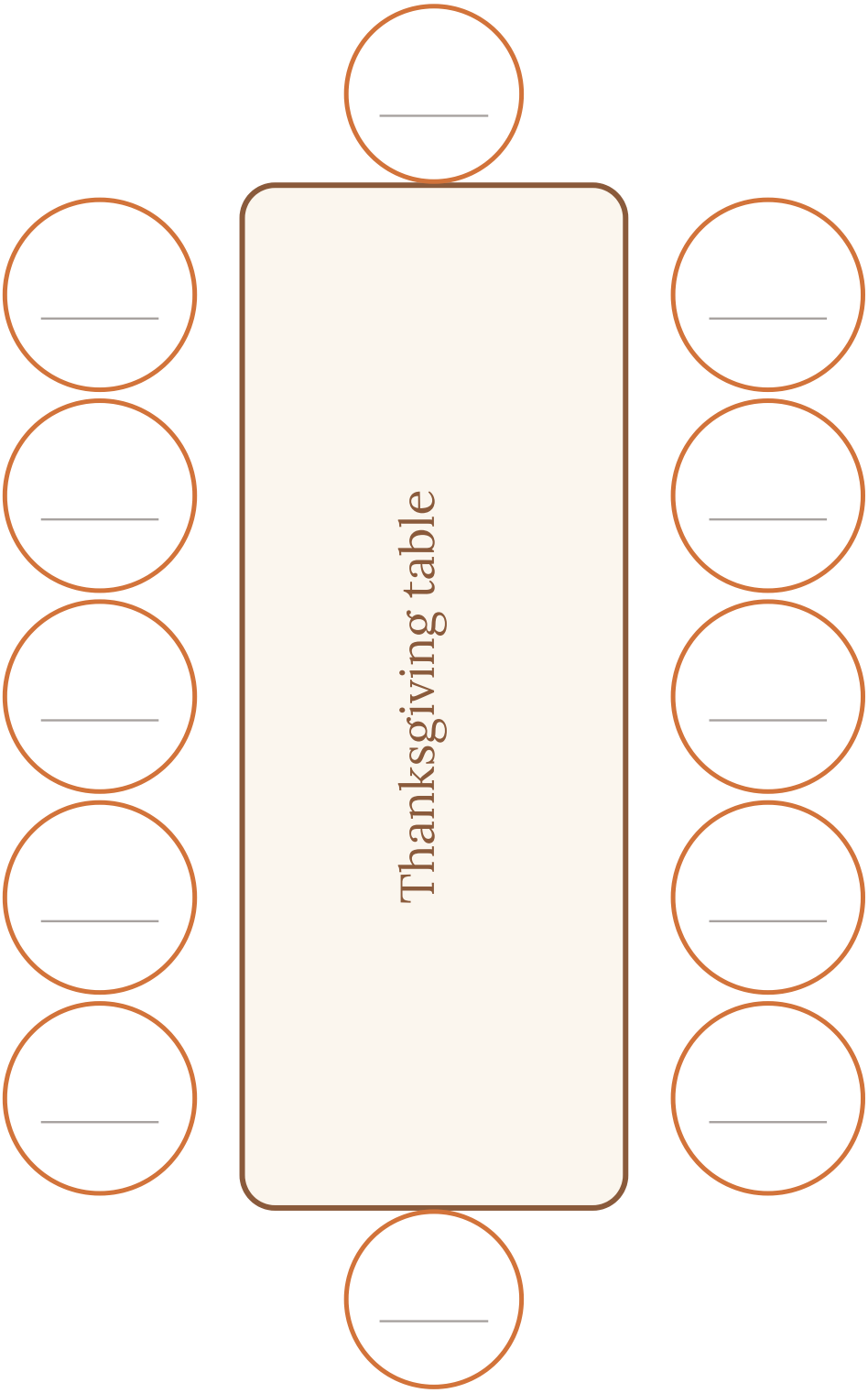
- [ ] Extra chairs and a kids' table
- [ ] Coat space and a spot for shoes
- [ ] Ice and a cooler for drinks
- [ ] Coffee, tea, cream and sugar
- [ ] To-go containers for leftovers
- [ ] Trash and recycling bags
- [ ] Games or a playlist
- [ ]
- [ ]

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Seating chart

LONG TABLE · 12 SEATS

Write a name on each seat. Tip: seat the cooks nearest the kitchen and seat new friends next to someone chatty.



Head of the table: _____

Nearest the kitchen: _____

Kids' table: _____

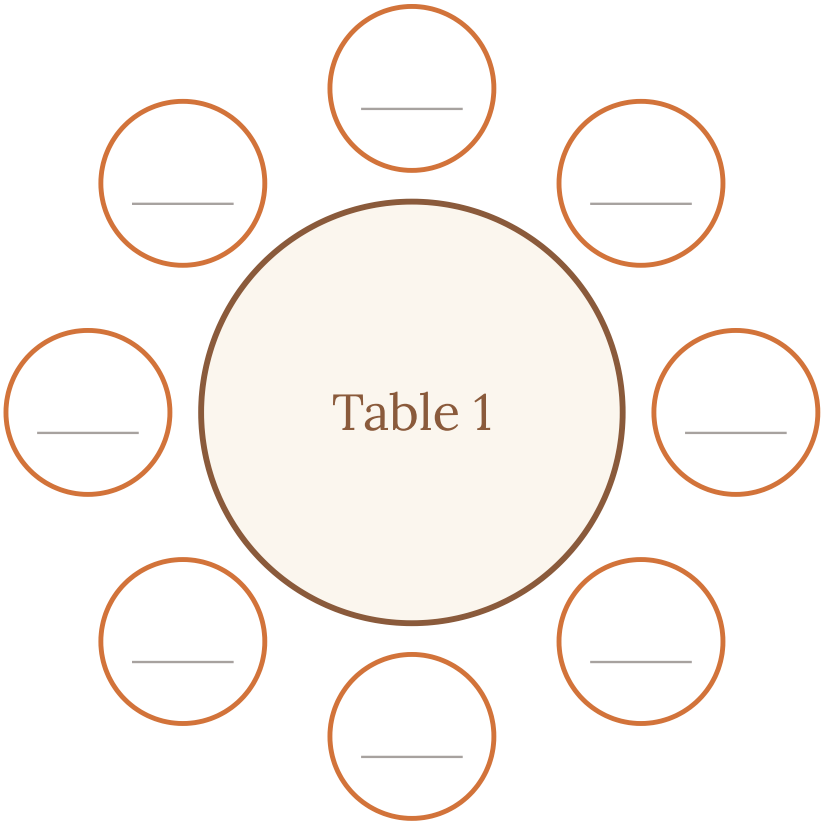
High chair / extra seats: _____

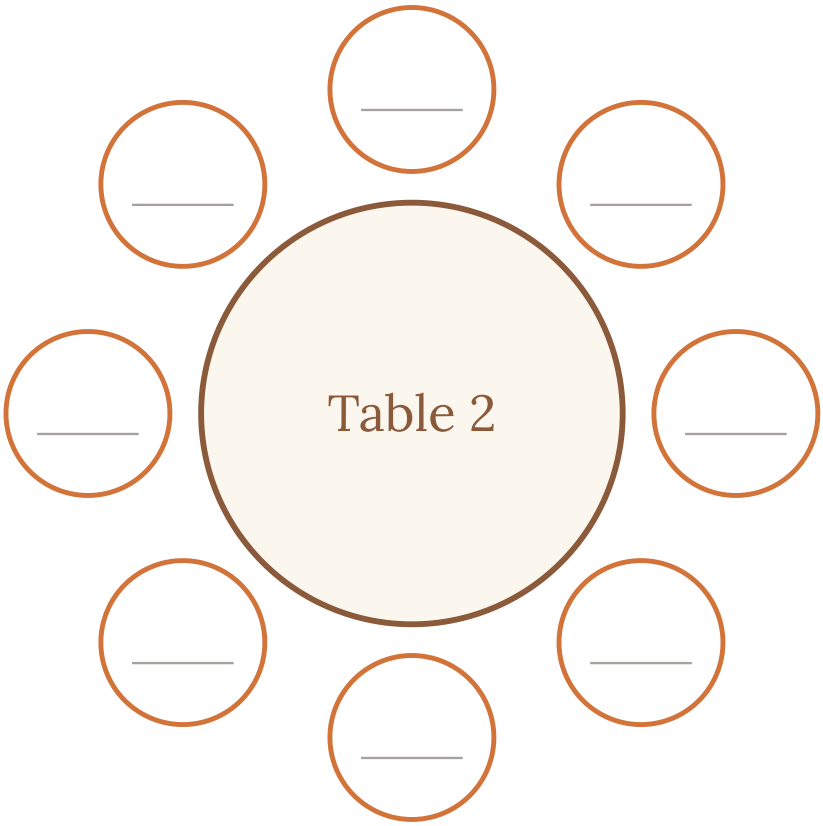
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Seating chart

TWO ROUND TABLES · 8 SEATS EACH

Use one or both tables (for example, grown-ups and kids). Write a name on each seat.





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Place cards

CUT ON DASHED LINES · FOLD ON DOTTED

So glad you're here

FOLD



HAPPY THANKSGIVING

So glad you're here

FOLD

HAPPY THANKSGIVING

So glad you're here

FOLD

HAPPY THANKSGIVING

So glad you're here

FOLD

HAPPY THANKSGIVING

So glad you're here

FOLD

HAPPY THANKSGIVING

So glad you're here

FOLD

HAPPY THANKSGIVING

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Place cards

CUT ON DASHED LINES · FOLD ON DOTTED



FOLD

GRATEFUL FOR YOU



FOLD

GRATEFUL FOR YOU



FOLD

GRATEFUL FOR YOU



FOLD

GRATEFUL FOR YOU



FOLD

GRATEFUL FOR YOU



FOLD

GRATEFUL FOR YOU

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Buffet food labels

CUT ON DASHED LINES · FOLD ON DOTTED

Help yourself!

FOLD

This dish is

_____

☐ Gluten-free ☐ Vegetarian ☐ Dairy-free

☐ Contains nuts

Help yourself!

FOLD

This dish is

_____

☐ Gluten-free ☐ Vegetarian ☐ Dairy-free

☐ Contains nuts

Help yourself!

FOLD

This dish is

_____

☐ Gluten-free ☐ Vegetarian ☐ Dairy-free

☐ Contains nuts

Help yourself!

FOLD

This dish is

_____

☐ Gluten-free ☐ Vegetarian ☐ Dairy-free

☐ Contains nuts

Help yourself!

FOLD

This dish is

_____

☐ Gluten-free ☐ Vegetarian ☐ Dairy-free

☐ Contains nuts

Help yourself!

FOLD

This dish is

_____

☐ Gluten-free ☐ Vegetarian ☐ Dairy-free

☐ Contains nuts

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After the feast

LEFTOVERS · THANK-YOUS · NEXT YEAR

Leftovers: who takes what

DISH	GOING HOME WITH	CONTAINER RETURNED
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

Notes for next year

What was a hit? What would you skip, buy more of or start earlier? Who should get a thank-you?

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